tool for filling information gaps (Abbott et al. 2015). For instance, the World Bank augments its US-provided emissions data with insights from the EU's EDGAR database, constructing a more comprehensive picture of global environmental trends. These partnerships allow IOs to pool resources and knowledge, enhancing their ability to address complex issues.

Information sharing among IOs offers several advantages. Agreements to share data typically bypass the need for member-state approval, enabling IO bureaucrats to act independently (Clark 2021). By tapping into one another's unique strengths, IOs can access specialized expertise, build more reliable datasets, and reduce redundancy. This interconnectedness also enhances their resilience; for example, during the eurozone crisis, the IMF and the World Bank collaborated to gather insights on European banking systems, helping to compensate for data withheld by uncooperative member states.

Interviews with IO officials underscore the importance of these strategies. One senior environmental IO official noted that when states fail to provide accurate data, the organization turns to alternative sources, including other IOs. This official explained, "We compare notes, involve [other IOs] in eventual papers, and ensure everyone is satisfied with the results."[7] Similarly, a UNAIDS official highlighted how collaboration with WHO and UNICEF helps validate questionable data, emphasizing that political motivations often influence member states' reporting.[8]

This collaborative approach has been applied across sectors. When the Trump administration restricted energy and environmental data shared with the World Bank, the organization signed agreements with Arab multilateral development banks to fill the gaps.[9] Similarly, in the security realm, the UN addressed the reluctance of the US government to share intelligence by partnering with the EU, NATO, the OPCW, and the African Union, bolstering its peacekeeping operations through shared resources.[10]

Despite its benefits, information sharing poses challenges. Member states may hesitate to share sensitive data because of fears of leaks or mistrust of partner IOs. Establishing the necessary infrastructure and protocols for collaboration can impose significant economic and political costs, while staff accustomed to existing systems may resist change. Moreover, IOs often compete for funding and influence, which can deter partnerships. Differences in ideologies and organizational cultures may further complicate cooperation (Clark 2022).[11]